



YOU ARE **35 WEEKS AND 4 DAYS**

31 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

Your baby's heart will beat quite fast, at between 110 and 160 beats every minute. Even after birth, your baby's heart will continue to beat at this speed. It will be several years before the heart rate is 70 or so beats per minute, the same as an adult.

“The lungs don't become fully functional until these final weeks, but important development is taking place now.”

If you imagine the lung as a tree, then the windpipe or “trachea” is the trunk of the tree. This then forms several branches or “bronchi,” which divide several times, like twigs, to then produce the most delicate structures: the alveoli or leaves of the tree. It is within the alveoli that gas exchange will take place.

The alveoli began to develop at 24 weeks but they continue to increase in number throughout the pregnancy. The alveoli contain surfactant-producing cells to keep them open and these now become fully functional.